

Zaid Daghash

Email: zaiddaghash@gmail.com Mobile: +974 50252706 LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/zaid-daghash/>
Portfolio: <https://zaid1201.github.io/portfolio/> Github: <https://github.com/Zaid1201?tab=repositories>
TryHackMe: <https://tryhackme.com/p/zaiddaghash>

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Computer Systems Engineering graduate with First Class Honours (GPA: 4.0) from The University of Sheffield and a current MSc Cyber Security student at Liverpool John Moores University. Experienced in project leadership, cross-functional collaboration, and delivering innovative engineering and software solutions under tight deadlines. Open to opportunities across all sectors to apply technical and problem-solving expertise while contributing to organizational success.

COMPETITIONS

Capture The Flag (CTF) – National Cyber Security Agency (NCSA)

2025

Rosewood Doha Hotel | Qatar

KEY PROJECTS

Security Automation Tool (Individual Project)

- Developed a Python SOAR utility to enrich IOC indicators via public APIs and generate triage reports.
- Automated noisy alert filtering and produced CSV/JSON summaries to speed SOC investigation workflows.

Burglar Alarm System with Facial Recognition (Project Lead)

- Directed a team of 4 students through a full project cycle, managing technical deliverables and timelines.
- Implemented a burglar alarm system using low embedded devices, programmed the functionality using C, and integrated facial recognition using MATLAB.

File Encryption & Security Tool

- Developed a Java-based GUI application that enables users to scan directories, view file metadata, and perform AES-256 encryption and decryption on files and folders.
- Implemented secure folder encryption with user-defined passwords and file integrity verification using SHA-256 hashing, with all actions logged automatically to a text file.
- Designed an intuitive interface using Java Swing, allowing for seamless navigation, real-time system feedback, and atomic file operations to prevent data exposure during encryption.

Bachelor's Degree Dissertation - Application of Statistical Analysis Methods to Assess Changes in Traffic Flow, Pollution Levels, and Peak Commuting Times in Sheffield (Pre- and Post-COVID-19)

- Analysed traffic and air-quality datasets (2019 vs 2023) using statistical modelling, hypothesis testing, and regression analysis.
- Identified regional variations in traffic flow and shifts in commuting peak times following the pandemic.
- Evaluated NO₂, PM_{2.5}, and PM₁₀ pollution trends, finding substantial NO₂ reductions but limited correlation with traffic volume changes.
- Produced insights to support urban planning and environmental policy decisions.

Reinforcement Learning Project (Academic Research)

- Implemented and compared Q-learning and SARSA algorithms to train an autonomous agent in different grid environments with deterministic, stochastic, and multi-target reward systems.
- Designed and tuned hyperparameters (learning rate, discount factor, exploration rate) to analyse algorithm performance across 5000+ episodes.
- Demonstrated the trade-offs between on-policy and off-policy learning, achieving optimized navigation strategies and improved convergence using policies such as epsilon-greedy and Softmax.

EDUCATION

Master of Science (MSc), Cyber Security

2025 - Present

Liverpool John Moores University – Oryx University | Qatar

- **Relevant modules include:** Computer Security, Network Security, Information Security Management, Ethical Hacking, Secure Systems

Bachelor of Engineering (BEng), Computer Systems Engineering

2021 - 2024

The University of Sheffield | United Kingdom | First Class Honours (GPA: 4.0)

- **Relevant modules include:** Introduction to Electric & Electronic Circuits, Digital Signal Processing, Mechatronics, Introduction to Systems Engineering & Software, Systems Engineering and Object-Oriented Programming, Computer Problem Solving and Object-Oriented Design, Systems Design and Security, Machine Learning, Computer Security and Forensics, Reinforcement Learning.

SKILLS

- **Cybersecurity Tools:** Wireshark, Nmap, Metasploit, Nessus, Splunk
- **OS:** Windows, Linux
- **Programming Languages:** Python, Java, C, MATLAB
- **Microsoft Tools:** Word, Excel, PowerPoint
- **Core Skills:** Analytical | Problem-Solving | Project Leadership | Cross-functional Collaboration | Adaptability | Communication
- **Languages:** English (Fluent), Arabic (Native)

CERTIFICATIONS

- **CompTIA: Security+ (in-progress), Network+ (in-progress)**
- **IBM: Introduction to AI (Honours) | Generative AI: Prompt Engineering Basics | Introduction to Software Engineering (Honours)**
- **HackerRank: Java (Basic) | Python (Basic)**